



Whistle Blower Policy

The Whistle blower Policy of UDAAN Society serves as a vital framework to promote transparency, accountability, and ethical conduct within the organization. It provides a secure and confidential mechanism for employees, volunteers, beneficiaries, and stakeholders to report any suspected misconduct, including fraud, corruption, abuse, or violations of law and policy.

UDAAN Society

8/140, RaghuvirPuri GT Road Aligarh-202001, UP, India

www.udaansociety.org

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Whistle Blower Policy

UDAAN Society

1. Introduction

UDAAN Society, a not-for-profit organization dedicated to empowering marginalized and under served communities, upholds the highest ethical standards in all its operations. This whistle blower Policy aims to foster an environment where individuals feel secure and supported in raising concerns about potential misconduct within the organization.

2. Objective

The objective of this policy is to:

- Encourage individuals to report unethical behavior, misconduct, or violations of law without fear of retaliation.
- Establish a clear mechanism for receiving, investigating, and resolving reported concerns.
- Safeguard the identity and rights of whistle blowers.
- Ensure accountability and transparency within UDAAN Society.

3. Scope and Applicability

This policy applies to all stakeholders, including but not limited to:

- Employees (permanent, temporary, contractual)
- Volunteers and interns
- Board members and trustees
- Consultants and service providers
- Beneficiaries and community members
- Any other individual or entity associated with UDAAN Society

4. Definitions

whistle blower: Any person who raises a concern about actual or suspected misconduct.

Misconduct: Includes but is not limited to:

- Fraud, bribery, corruption, or embezzlement
- Financial irregularities or misappropriation of funds
- Breach of confidentiality or data protection
- Sexual harassment or exploitation
- Abuse of power or authority



- Discrimination or violation of human rights
- Non-compliance with laws, regulations, or internal policies
- Threats to health, safety, or the environment

5. Guiding Principles

- Good Faith: The whistle blower must believe the information being disclosed is true to the best of their knowledge.
- No Retaliation: UDAAN Society guarantees protection from retaliation for genuine whistle blowers.
- Confidentiality: The identity of the whistle blower and the details of the concern will be kept confidential, unless required by law or necessary for investigation.
- Transparency and Accountability: All allegations will be handled objectively, thoroughly, and in a timely manner.

6. Reporting Mechanisms

Concerns may be raised through any of the following:

- Email: mail@udaansociety.org
- Phone: +91-9837067681
- Postal Mail: Marked "Confidential" to:

The President

UDAAN Society

8/140, Raghuvir Puri GT Road Aligarh-202001 UP

- In Person: With the designated whistle blower Officer or an assigned committee member.

Anonymous complaints are acceptable but must provide sufficient details to enable investigation.

7. Receipt and Handling of Reports

Upon receipt of a complaint:

- The whistle blower Officer will acknowledge the complaint within 7 working days.
- An initial review will be conducted to assess credibility and materiality.
- If deemed appropriate, a formal investigation will follow.
- A written record will be maintained of all reported concerns, investigations, and outcomes.



8. Investigation Process

- The investigation shall be conducted by the designated Internal Investigation Committee or an independent third party if required.
- The committee will collect evidence, interview relevant persons, and maintain thorough documentation.
- The investigation should be completed within 30 days, extendable based on complexity.
- The findings will be submitted to the Executive Director and/or the Governing Board for necessary action.

9. Protection to the whistle blower

UDAAN Society assures that:

- whistle blowers raising concerns in good faith will not suffer harassment, retaliation, or victimization.
- Any act of retaliation or intimidation will lead to disciplinary action against the perpetrator.
- If the whistle blower feels threatened, they may request special protection or confidentiality safeguards.

10. False or Malicious Allegations

Allegations found to be deliberately false or made with malicious intent will result in disciplinary action against the complainant. However, no action will be taken against those who report in good faith, even if the allegations prove unfounded.

11. Roles and Responsibilities

- whistle blower Officer: Primary contact for receiving complaints, responsible for initiating the investigation process.
- Investigation Committee: Conducts fact-finding and submits recommendations.
- Governing Board: Final authority on actions to be taken.
- HR/Legal Team: Provides support where legal or personnel matters are involved.

12. Documentation and Reporting

All complaints, evidence, investigation reports, and resolutions will be securely archived and reviewed periodically for trends or systemic issues. A summary of whistle blower activities may be included in the organization's annual report (without revealing identities).

13. Policy Review and Amendment

This policy will be reviewed annually or as required by changes in laws or organizational needs. Updates will be approved by the Governing Board and disseminated to all stakeholders.



14. Communication and Training

The policy will be included in induction programs, volunteer handbooks, and staff manuals. Regular awareness sessions and training will be conducted to reinforce its importance and procedures.

